

**SOMALIA**

Capital city: Mogadishu
Area: 246,199 sq miles (637,657 sq km)
Population: 9,900,000
Official languages: Somali, Arabic
Major religion: Muslim 98%, Christian 2%
Government: None at present
Currency: Somali shilling
Adult literacy rate: 24%
Life expectancy: 47 years
People per doctor: 20,000
Televisions: 15 per 1,000 people

DJIBOUTI

Capital city: Djibouti
Area: 8,880 sq miles (23,000 sq km)
Population: 5,500,000
Official languages: Arabic, French
Major religions: Muslim 94%, other 6%
Government: Multiparty democracy
Currency: Djibouti franc
Adult literacy rate: 66%
Life expectancy: 44 years
People per doctor: 10,000
Televisions: 45 per 1,000 people

ERITREA

Capital city: Asmara
Area: 46,842 sq miles (121,320 sq km)
Population: 4,100,000
Official languages: Tigrinya, Arabic, English
Major religions: Christian 45%, Muslim 45%, other 10%
Government: Provisional government
Currency: Nakfa
Adult literacy rate: 57%
Life expectancy: 51 years
People per doctor: 20,000
Televisions: 14 per 1,000 people

SOMALIA

SOMALIA GAINED INDEPENDENCE from Italy and Britain in 1960. However, this diverse country with a rich history did not achieve peace. Since 1991, Somalia has been torn apart by civil war, resulting in widespread famine. Many Somalis are nomadic herders, wandering through the dry, barren countryside with their camels, sheep, and goats in search of food and water.

**RELIEF CAMPS**

Since war broke out, many thousands of Somalis have moved into relief camps for food, safety, and shelter. The troubles, however, have made it difficult for international aid to be distributed. Up to one million Somalis sought refuge in neighboring countries, although many began to return as the fighting decreased in 2000 and 2001.

**MOGADISHU**

Mogadishu is the capital of Somalia and its major port and commercial center. The various styles of the buildings reflect the history of the country. Arabs settled there in the 9th century, and it became a European colony in the 19th century.

**WOMEN'S DRESS**

Many Somali women wear a cotton, sarilike garment, called a *guntimo*, and a shawl, called a *garbasaar*. Unlike many Muslims in other countries, Somali women do not wear veils that cover the face.

DJIBOUTI

THE SMALL, MAINLY DESERT country of Djibouti became independent in 1977. Many of its people are nomads. Djibouti is of great importance to this part of Africa because of its port and capital city, also called Djibouti. The country's economy relies almost entirely on income from the port.



Fishing is a developing industry in Djibouti. Fishermen set out from the port of Djibouti on the Gulf of Aden.

ERITREA

AFTER 20 YEARS OF WAR, the mountainous land of Eritrea effectively became independent of Ethiopia in 1991. However, relations remained tense and a new war broke out in 1998. Ethiopian troops finally left the country in 2001, leaving the Eritrean people to rebuild their shattered economy.



This theater in Asmara, the capital of Eritrea, is an example of the fine Italian-style architecture found in parts of the city. Eritrea was once an Italian colony.

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